after quarreling with Shimon and returned later as head of the Israeli Atomic Energy Commission. I went under the name of Shaul Eldar (Hebraization of names in public service was compulsory at the time), and I was privy to one of the most secret domains in the country. I had probably been hired because of my fluent knowledge of French, as France and French companies were massively involved in the construction of the Israeli nuclear installations.

I am telling this because, at the time, this extremely daring and complex enterprise was in the hands of extremely daring but very responsible people: Ben-Gurion, as prime minister and minister of defense, and Peres, as vice-minister of defense, and particularly in charge of the nuclear effort. In years past, Netanyahu was generally considered as a cautious person as far as military decisions were concerned (Gaza, etc.). Now, however, since his judicial travails and with this coalition in hand, he seems to have thrown caution to the wind and is ready to risk everything to save his own hide.

Sara'le declared today that yesterday's vaudeville could have ended in murder …

Ben-Gvir is threatening Gallant because Gallant ordered the arrest of Huwara incendiaries who threatened army personnel. Levin apparently threatened Netanyahu because he planned to suggest compromise regarding the judicial reform in his address to the nation. The prime minister changed the address and dropped the compromise. What a shame!

Friday, March 3

Gallant saved himself: the army used force to stop left-wing demonstrators from entering Huwara to express their solidarity with the Palestinian population. As I said at the outset of this diary, one would like to eat as much as one wants to puke.